CMS Program Statistics: A Methodological Overview

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Table of Contents

1. Background 3
2. Medicare Enrollment 3
3. Medicare Providers 4
4. Medicare Use and Payments by Service Type 4

1. Background

The Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services (CMS) has prepared the CMS Program Statistics, an online statistical report that includes tables describing characteristics of the Medicare-covered populations, use of services, and expenditures under these programs, as well as Medicare providers serving beneficiaries.

The primary data source for the CMS Program Statistics come from the CMS administrative enrollment, claims, and encounter data for Medicare beneficiaries enrolled in the Medicare program. The Medicare data are available from the CMS Chronic Conditions Data Warehouse (CCW), a database with 100% of Medicare enrollment, Part A and Part B Original Medicare (also referred to as fee-for-service) claims data, data for Part D prescription drug events, and Medicare Advantage encounter data. Detailed information on the CCW is available from the CCW website, www.ccwdata.org.

2. Medicare Enrollment

The Medicare Enrollment reports include counts, nationally, by state and other areas, demographic characteristics, and health care delivery (Original Medicare and Medicare Advantage & Other Health Plans) for the following:

- Medicare Part A and Part B Enrollees
- Newly Enrolled Beneficiaries
- Medicare Deaths
- Medicare-Medicaid Enrollees (or dual-eligible beneficiaries)

In addition to the above listed Medicare Enrollment reports, the CMS Program Statistics includes reports with Medicare Part D enrollee counts, nationally, by state and other areas, and demographic characteristics.

The Medicare Part A and Part B enrollee counts are determined using a person-year methodology. For each calendar year, total person-year counts are determined by summing the total number of months that each beneficiary is enrolled in Part A and/or Part B during the year ad dividing by 12. Using this methodology, a beneficiary's partial-year enrollment may be counted in more than 1 category (i.e., coverage type, health care delivery, and dual status), where appropriate. This method differs from enrollee counts previously reported in the Medicare and Medicaid Statistical Supplement, which are based on a mid-year snapshot where beneficiaries were counted as enrolled in Parts A and/or B on their respective July enrollment status. While both methods arrive at an average monthly enrollment count, the person-year method more closely represents true enrollment and is the method generally used by the insurance industry.

Newly enrolled counts are based on beneficiaries with a coverage start date between January 1st and December 31st of the reported calendar year. Total deaths are based on beneficiaries with a date of death between January 1st and December 31st of the reported calendar year.

Medicare-Medicaid enrollee counts are determined by summing the number of months that each Medicare-Medicaid enrollee is enrolled in both Medicare and Medicaid during the calendar year and dividing by 12. Medicare-Medicaid enrollees are typically classified according to the benefits for which they are eligible. These benefits vary by income and assets at a given point in time. There are 7 separate categories of eligibility.

The Medicare Part D enrollee counts are determined using a person-year methodology. For each calendar year, total person-year counts are determined by summing the total number of months that each beneficiary is enrolled in Part D during the year and dividing by 12. Using this methodology, a beneficiary's partial-year enrollment in Part D may be counted in more than 1 category (i.e., plan type and low-income subsidy eligibility category), where appropriate.

Race code counts are based on the Research Triangle Institute (RTI) race codes[1].

The area of residence is determined based on a beneficiary's residence at the end of the calendar year. Medicare beneficiaries residing in foreign countries are entitled to covered services upon returning to the United States.

3. Medicare Providers

The Medicare Provider report include tables with counts on the following:

- Medicare-certified institutional providers (e.g., hospitals, skilled nursing facilities, home health agencies, hospices, outpatient facilities, etc), nationally and by State. These tables report counts of active and Medicare-certified providers available in the Provider of Services (POS) file, a file containing data on characteristics of hospitals and other types of healthcare facilities.
- Medicare non-institutional providers (e.g. physicians, non-physician practitioners, and suppliers), by specialty and State. These tables are based upon services provided by Medicare Part B physician, non-physician practitioner, and supplier as reflected on fee-for-service Part B claims data on the CCW. Physicians, non-physician practitioners, and suppliers may be counted in more than a single specialty and in more than a single state.

4. Medicare Use and Payments by Service Type

The Medicare Use and Payment summary reports contain tables with utilization and payment data for the following service types:

- Inpatient Hospital
- Skilled Nursing Facility
- Physician/Non-Physician Practitioner/Supplier
- Outpatient Facility
- Hospice
- Home Health Agency

In addition to the above service types, the Medicare Use and Payment summary reports include tables with Medicare Part D utilization and drug cost data and tables on Medicare Premiums.

[1] For more details on RTI_RACE_CD variable, please see: https://resdac.org/cms-data/variables/research-triangle-institute-rti-race-code.

Below are details for the specific reports:

Inpatient Hospital:

Original Medicare Inpatient Hospital

The Original Medicare Inpatient Hospital tables include utilization and program payments for all inpatient hospitals (including short-stay hospitals, critical access hospitals, long-term care hospitals, inpatient psychiatric facilities, inpatient rehabilitation facilities, religious nonmedical health care institutions, children's hospitals, and other hospitals) by Original Medicare (or fee-for-service) beneficiaries. Tables 5-9 are specific to short-stay hospitals paid under Inpatient Prospective Payment System. Table 10 reports counts and payment amounts for special-category hospitals: cancer hospitals, disproportionate share hospitals, Medicare dependent hospitals, and sole community hospitals. The data source for these special-category hospitals is the CMS Cost Reports.

All tables are based upon inpatient hospital fee-for-service claims with covered days greater than 0 or Medicare program payment amounts greater than 0. The reported "per enrollee" rates are calculated using Original Medicare Part A enrollment as the denominator.

Medicare Advantage Inpatient Hospital

The Medicare Advantage Inpatient Hospital tables include utilization for inpatient hospitals by Medicare Advantage beneficiaries. Tables 1-3 are not available at this time. Table 4 includes Medicare Advantage utilization by inpatient hospital type, and Tables 5-7 present Medicare Advantage utilization for short-stay hospitals only. The reported "per enrollee" rates are calculated using Medicare Advantage Part A enrollment as the denominator.

The data reported in these tables are based on inpatient hospital encounter records submitted by Medicare Advantage Organizations to CMS. An algorithm was applied to categorize inpatient hospital encounter records by hospital type in a way that is consistent with fee-for-service hospital categorization, using the CMS Certification Number (CCN), which is not present on encounter records. For more information on the algorithm, please visit the Medicare Advantage Encounter Data Analytical Methods.

Skilled Nursing Facility:

Original Medicare Skilled Nursing Facility

All Original Medicare Skilled Nursing Facility tables are based upon Medicare skilled nursing facility fee-for-service claims with covered days greater than 0. The reported "per enrollee" rates are calculated using Original Medicare Part A enrollment as the denominator.

Medicare Advantage Skilled Nursing Facility

All Medicare Advantage Skilled Nursing Facility tables include utilization for skilled nursing facilities by Medicare Advantage beneficiaries. The reported "per enrollee" rates are calculated using Medicare Advantage Part A enrollment as the denominator.

The data reported in these tables are based on skilled nursing facility encounter records submitted by Medicare Advantage Organizations to CMS. For more information on the data development of the Medicare Advantage encounter data, please visit the Medicare Advantage Encounter Data Analytical Methods.

Physician/Non-Physician Practitioner/Supplier:

Original Medicare Physician/Non-Physician Practitioner/Supplier

The Original Medicare Physician/Non-Physician Practitioner/Supplier tables include fee-for-service utilization and program payments for physicians, non-physician practitioners, limited-license practitioners, and durable medical equipment, prosthetic and orthotic (DMEPOS) suppliers. The reported "per enrollee" rates are calculated using Original Medicare Part B enrollment as the denominator.

Medicare Advantage Physician/Non-Physician Practitioner/Supplier

The Medicare Advantage Physician/Non-Physician Practitioner/Supplier tables include utilization for practitioners and suppliers by Medicare Advantage beneficiaries. The reported "per enrollee" rates are calculated using Medicare Advantage Part B enrollment as the denominator.

The data reported in these tables are based on practitioner encounter records submitted by Medicare Advantage Organizations to CMS. For more information on the data development of the Medicare Advantage encounter data, please visit the Medicare Advantage Encounter Data Analytical Methods.

Medicare Outpatient Facility:

Original Medicare Outpatient Facility

The Original Medicare Outpatient Facility tables include fee-for-service utilization and program payments for all outpatient facilities, including outpatient hospitals, critical access hospitals, rural health clinics, community mental health centers, federally qualified health centers, outpatient dialysis facilities, comprehensive outpatient rehabilitation facilities, and other outpatient facilities. The tables exclude fee-for-service claims from physician and ambulatory surgical centers. The reported "per enrollee" rates are calculated using Original Medicare Part B enrollment as the denominator.

Medicare Advantage Outpatient Facility

The Medicare Advantage Outpatient Facility tables include utilization for outpatient facilities by Medicare Advantage beneficiaries. The reported "per enrollee" rates are calculated using Medicare Advantage Part B enrollment as the denominator.

The data reported in these tables are based on outpatient facility encounter records submitted by Medicare Advantage Organizations to CMS. For more information on the data development of the Medicare Advantage encounter data, please visit the Medicare Advantage Encounter Data Analytical Methods.

Medicare Hospice:

The Medicare Hospice tables include fee-for-service utilization and program payments for hospices. The tables limit the reporting of hospice days to utilization days occurring within the specified calendar year and may not reflect all of a beneficiary's utilization days for an entire hospice episode of care. The "per enrollee" rates are based on enrollees in Original Medicare and Medicare Advantage & other health plans combined, because once a beneficiary enrolled in Medicare Advantage or other health plan elects the hospice benefit, his or her Medicare benefits revert to fee-for-service.

Original Medicare Home Health Agency:

The Original Medicare Home Health Agency tables include fee-for-service utilization and program payments for home health agencies. The tables report utilization and expenditure data from home health Part A and Part B claims with home health agency services greater than 0, within the specified calendar year. Services provided by home health agencies to beneficiaries who are not under a home health plan of care are excluded in the reporting. The calculated "per enrollee" rates are based on Original Medicare beneficiaries with Part A and/or Part B coverage.

Original Medicare Part A and Part B Summary:

The Original Medicare Part A and Part B Summary tables are a compilation of fee-for-service utilization and expenditure data reported in the tables from the Original Medicare service-specific sections described above. This section includes a breakout of Part A and Part B fee-for-service home health agency services, separately.

Medicare Part D Utilization:

The Medicare Part D Utilization tables include utilization and drug cost data for Medicare Part D. The trend tables report Part D utilization data (including utilizers, average prescription drug events, generic dispensing rates, and average unique drug products per utilizer) and Part D drug costs (including brand name and generic) by type of Part D plan (stand-alone prescription drug plan and Medicare Advantage prescription drug plan). The demographic and state tables report utilizers, average prescription drug events (fills), and average Part D gross drug costs by type of Part D plan. Additionally, this section also includes yearly trend, demographic, state tables that present utilization and expenditure data by Part D coverage phase.

Medicare Premiums:

The Medicare Premiums tables include counts of Medicare Part A and Part B premium beneficiaries, Part A and Part B premium amounts, and counts of Part A and Part B beneficiaries paying a penalty, including the Part A and Part B penalty amounts. Additionally, tables with counts of Medicare Part D base and supplemental premium beneficiaries and premium amounts, as well as counts of Part D beneficiaries paying a penalty and Part D penalty amounts are included. The Part B and Part D premium tables include Income Related Monthly Adjustment Amount (IRMAA) beneficiaries and IRMAA amounts.